

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 Aligned | AC9E6LY04 | Year 6 | Complex Texts, Perspective & Sustained Argument

LEARNING INTENTION
I am learning to analyse complex texts by examining perspective, evaluating evidence and constructing sustained, well-reasoned arguments.

READING STRATEGY
Identify the author's perspective and purpose. Evaluate the quality of evidence. Consider whose voice is missing. Challenge assumptions and construct your own reasoned position.

READ THE PASSAGE — READ IT 3 TIMES!

For centuries, creativity was considered a mysterious **gift** — either you had it or you did not. Modern neuroscience has **fundamentally** challenged this assumption.

Brain imaging studies reveal that creativity involves a dynamic interplay between three **neural networks**: the default mode network (imagination), the executive control network (focus) and the salience network (which switches between them).

Crucially, **divergent thinking** — generating many possible solutions — can be developed through deliberate practice.

Studies show that **boredom** is actually a catalyst for creativity: the mind wanders, makes unexpected **connections** and generates novel ideas.

Constant digital **stimulation**, however, prevents this essential mental wandering.

Research also shows that **sleep** and physical exercise significantly enhance creative output. The implication is **profound**: creativity is not a rare talent but a **learnable** skill available to anyone willing to cultivate it.

VOCABULARY HELPER

neural networks = connected groups of brain cells that process information

divergent thinking = thinking that generates many different possible solutions

catalyst = something that causes or speeds up a change

stimulation = something that activates or excites the brain

cultivate = develop something through effort and care

WARM UP — BEFORE YOU READ

Do you consider yourself creative? Has anyone ever told you that you are or are not creative? Write 2 sentences:

A — COMPREHENSION

1. What did people traditionally believe about creativity?

2. Name the 3 neural networks involved in creativity:

3. What does boredom do for creativity?

4. What does the final sentence say about who can be creative?

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept personal reflection with 2 sentences.

A1. That creativity was a mysterious gift you either had or did not. A2. Default mode network, executive control network, salience network. A3. The mind wanders, makes unexpected connections and generates novel ideas. A4. It is a learnable skill available to everyone.

B1. Creativity can be developed — structure: old belief → scientific challenge → evidence → implication. B2. Accept: Technology companies, educators focused on productivity, or people who believe talent is innate might disagree.

C: Profound = deeply significant/far-reaching — the author signals this is a paradigm shift, not a minor finding. 'Either you had it or you did not' — challenges the fixed-mindset belief about creativity.

High Five! You are a Super Reader! ✓
Colour a star each time you read the passage aloud:



EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Write a proposal to your school principal arguing for a 'Creative Thinking Hour' each week. Include the scientific rationale, the format and how outcomes will be measured.

PARENT TIP

Give your child 30 minutes of unstructured time with no screens. After, discuss: 'What thoughts came to you? Did you feel bored? Did any interesting ideas emerge?'

TEACHER TIP

Connect to the arts and wellbeing. Students explore divergent thinking through creativity challenges. Discuss the difference between structured and unstructured learning time.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- [] I can explain how the author builds an argument using evidence
- [] I can identify language that challenges assumptions
- [] I can write a proposal using scientific reasoning